

Customer's view on convenience products
packet design.
Bachelor Thesis

Supervisor:

Mgr. Hana Porkertová, Ph.D.

Mohammad Mahin Intasher Chowdhury

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Abstrakt

Tato studie se zabývá tím, jak obal ovlivňuje pocity studentů v Brně v České republice a kde se v jejich mysli ocitne. Obal je způsob, jakým je navržen obal nebo obal výrobku a jak je plánováno jeho uvedení na trh. Mezi obalové materiály patří kartony, plastové plechovky, sáčky, lahve a sklo. Různé školní podniky zaznamenaly posun v roli obalů od lokálních k národním. Podniky nemohou přeceňovat hodnotu obalů, protože jsou mocným prodejním nástrojem. Obaly mají dva hlavní úkoly: uchovávat věci v bezpečí a pomáhat lidem je najít. Zatímco propagační aspekt obalu se snaží, aby výrobek chtělo více lidí, uzavření je nezbytné pro efektivní dodávku. Práce zkoumá názory zákazníků na obaly polotovarů a jejich nákupní chování. Zkoumá také, jak lze obal využít jako marketingovou strategii pro spotřební zboží. Jako případové studie byly použity tři firmy vyrábějící nealkoholické nápoje: Coca-Cola, Pepsi a Kofola. Teorie sebepojetí se zabývá tím, jak obal ovlivňuje to, jak o sobě lidé smýšlejí Třetina studentů zmíněných univerzit vypije každý týden alespoň jednu až dvě lahve (nebo více) své oblíbené značky. Tato studie byla provedena na třech vysokých školách v Brně v České republice. Cílem této práce je zjistit více o tom, jak obal ovlivňuje image značky a jak se zákazníci rozhodují pro nákup určitých balených výrobků. Soubor této studie tvoří vysokoškolští studenti ze tří nejlepších univerzit v Brně v České republice Respondenti byli formou osobního rozhovoru požádáni, aby se podělili o své zkušenosti s obalem své oblíbené značky nealkoholického nápoje. Odborníci kontrolovali dotazník, aby se ujistili, že každá položka měří to, co měřit má. Jako měřítko pro měření odpovídajících odpovědí a vyvození závěrů byly použity údaje z předchozích zkušeností (historie). Otázky typu „co“ často znamenají, že se někdo chce dozvědět více. Historie, experimenty a případové studie jsou nejlepšími způsoby, jak odpovědět na otázky „proč“ a „jak“. Tato studie se bude zabývat tím, jak obal ovlivňuje celé rozhodování zákazníka o koupi výrobku. Analýza dat zahrnuje shromažďování a třídění údajů, které výzkumníkovi umožní vyvodit podstatné závěry. Nápoje Coke a Pepsi jsou oblíbenější než nápoje Kofola. Velikost a tvar obalu ovlivňují úsudek zákazníka o kvalitě výrobku. Design obalů, jako je velikost, tvar, barva a forma, významně ovlivňuje způsob, jakým lidé nakupují. Obaly používají design, barvy, tvary, grafiku a materiály, aby přiměly příjemce k jejich otevření. Obal musí působit jako tichý prodejce a získat pozornost nakupujícího. Balení výrobku je proces navrhování a výroby obalu nebo obalu pro výrobek. Informuje lidi o diskriminaci výrobku, jeho složení, způsobu použití, datu

spotřeby, ceně a varování. Špatný obal je problémem většiny společností, tvrdí mnoho lidí, kteří na tomto projektu pracovali.

Klíčová slova: Zákazníci, pohodlí, vnímání, design výrobku, Česká republika

ABSTRACT

This study looks at how packaging affects students in Brno, Czech Republic feel about a product and where it ends up in their minds. Packaging is how a product's container or wrapper is designed and planned of its release. Packaging materials include cartons, plastic cans, bags, bottles, and glass. Various school businesses have seen a shift in the role of packaging from the local to the national. Companies can't overestimate the value of packaging because it is a powerful selling tool. Packaging has two main jobs: keeping things safe and helping people find them. While the promotional aspect of packaging tries to make more people want the product, confinement is essential for efficient delivery. The thesis investigates customers' views on convenience product packaging and their purchasing behaviour. It also investigates how packaging might be used as a marketing strategy for consumer goods. The three soft drink firms utilised as case studies were Coca-Cola, Pepsi, and Kofola. The Theory of Self-Conception looks at how packaging affects how people think about themselves. One-third of students at the mentioned universities drink at least one to two bottles (or more) of their favourite brand every week. This study was based on three universities in Brno, the Czech Republic. This thesis aims to learn more about how packaging affects a brand's image and how customers choose to buy certain packaged products. The population of this study is made up of university students from the top three universities in Brno, Czech Republic. Respondents were asked by face-to-face interview to share their experience with their favourite soft drink brand package. Experts looked over the questionnaire to ensure that each item measured what it was supposed to measure. Data from previous experiences (history) was used as a yardstick to measure the corresponding answers and draw conclusions. "What" questions often mean that someone wants to find out more. History, experiments, and case studies are the best ways to answer "why" and "how". This study will look at how packaging affects a customer's entire decision to buy a product. Data analysis entails gathering and sorting data to allow the researcher to derive the essential conclusions. Coke and Pepsi are more popular than Kofola drinks. Package size and shape affect customer judgments about the quality of a product. Packaging design, such as size, shape, colour, and form, significantly impacts how people buy

things. Packages use design, colours, shapes, graphics, and materials to get the recipient to open them. The package must act as a silent salesman and get the attention of the shopping person. Product packaging is the process of designing and making the container or wrapper for a product. It tells people about the product's discrimination, ingredients, mode of use, expiration date, price, and warning. Poor packaging is an issue for most companies, say many people who worked on this project.

Keywords: Customers, Convenience, Perception, product design, Czech Republic

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

Buying and using packaging as a factor is not well understood by many people. No known research has defined the concept of customer convenience on packaged products or investigated how it is measured. We talk about the different ideas of convenient packaging and how time and effort costs affect people's perceptions of how easy it is to get things done. Consumers have always been interested in products that save them time and money. Some parts of the convenience construct are only relevant to items that are made. People who shop can benefit from all types of convenience that make it easier to save time or effort. This is called service **convenience**.

A good product packaging strategy is often linked to success. Packaging affects how people feel about a product and where it ends up in their minds. Because brands are growing more popular and there are so many different products available at the point of sale, it takes more effort to distinguish them from their competitors. Traditional mass media marketing is being phased out to make matters even more complicated, favouring point-of-sale advertising and communication. This study will look at how packaging can help you position your product on the market. Tests were conducted to link each positioning approach to certain package elements (colour, typography, shape, image). Organisers are becoming more conscious of how packaging can differentiate and distinguish items, particularly in the case of essentially homogenous, perishable consumer goods. As a result of this, this study was created.

1.1 BACKGROUND OF THE STUDY

Purchasing goods and services that are valuable enough to be recognised as increasingly important by customers is referred to as consumer convenience (Berry, Seiders & Grewal, 2002). Customers (students) can choose from a list of pre-selected goods and services that they can trust. Comfort is a significant factor in advertising and promoting these goods and products (Berry, Seiders & Grewal, 2002). This means that all products that save the consumer time and effort in purchasing manufactured goods quickly are linked to the consumer's convenience. It

is possible to reduce the amount of time required to purchase, store, and use products by altering packaging, product size, and other design elements (Berry, Seiders & Grewal, 2002).

To put it simply, the packaging is the process by which a product's container or wrapper is designed and planned in advance of its release (Ampuero & Vila 2006). To sell something, you must have a collection of tangible and intangible goods and services. Anything created as a result of a process to satisfy a need is called an invention (Ampuero & Vila 2006). Increasing numbers of consumers are eager to experiment with new products and services that meet their needs and expectations. Any product or service will be more appealing to customers if they have a cheerful outlook towards it (Ampuero & Vila 2006). Most school's environment businesses still sell their products in their original packaging. Other than that, the only thing visible is a smattering of packets in an array of hues and sizes. Students who are the significant consumers' purchasing decisions are heavily influenced by packaging, which plays a vital role in marketing communications for goods (Abdullah, Kalam & Akterujjaman, 2013). Various school businesses have seen a shift in packaging from the local to the national, guiding a product not to be damaged or mishandled in the process (Abdullah, Kalam & Akterujjaman, 2013). In the marketing planning process, it is necessary to consider how a customer perceives, thinks, or reacts to purchases of products or services influenced by factors that the market cannot control (Abdullah, Kalam & Akterujjaman, 2013). Cultural, social, personal, and psychological aspects are all considered. Packaging materials include cartons, plastic cans, bags, bottles, and glass. Abdullah, Kalam, and Akterujjaman (2013) say that each of these items has been well-received because they help sell products (Abdullah, Kalam, and Akterujjaman, 2013).

My bachelor's thesis aims to figure out who the customers are, what they think about convenience product packages, and what they do when they want to buy a product or service.

Customer's (students) views on the product:

- What do they think of the product design and functionality of their favourite soft drink brand?
- What do they like about their favourite soft drink brand in general?
- How is the product designed?
- Why are they drawn to a product?

- If a company has products or services, how much weight does package branding put on them?

Customer-oriented businesses can't overestimate the value of packaging because it is a powerful selling tool that makes people want to buy the goods. This is why packaging is so vital to any business. Salespeople sell things, but the packaging does its job better when the product package looks good and is easy to open and close.

Packaging has two main jobs: keeping things safe and helping people find them. While the promotional aspect of packaging tries to make more people want the product, confinement is essential for efficient delivery. The packaging of convenience goods is usually more important than that of shopping or speciality items. Packaging is necessary depending on how customers buy things. Many businesses have found that packaging significantly impacts how people think and what they choose to keep. As a result, it is essential to look more closely at the package and its features to figure out which of these things is most important to the customer when making a purchasing decision.

On the other hand, Lamb et al. (2004) says that packaging plays four essential roles. This study focuses on these roles to see how packaging affects customers' purchasing decisions for high-quality products in the school market. All the Kotler's dimensions can be found in these four areas. They each have a different name, but they cover all of them. People find it easier to store and use products and recycle them, and environmental damage is lessened.

protection of products and consumers

Product safety is a critical aspect of the consumer's perception of product quality. Packages are safeguarded against breakage, evaporation, spillage, spoilage, light, heat, cold, and various other circumstances. Packaging that does not adequately protect the goods has the potential to cause further damage and waste.

Product Promotion

Packaging's promotional role should be examined. It can be utilised to attract the attention of buyers and entice them to investigate the goods. Packaging design is vital in supermarket products because its primary role is to help separate them from one another. As customers spend less time planning shopping trips and reading than ever before, visual images are more important than ever in drawing them. Content promotion is a crucial packaging goal, especially

in self-service shopping. The package must work as a silent salesperson and draw the shopper's attention. Packaging is becoming an increasingly important component of a marketing strategy. Businesses view packaging as a means of attracting people to new and established brands. Packages use design, colours, shapes, graphics, and materials to persuade the recipient. Businesses view packaging as a means of attracting people to new and established brands. Packages attempt to influence consumers' views and purchase behaviour through design, colours, forms, graphics, and materials (Lamb et al., 2004).

1.2 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

As a result of the school markets' and business centres' dismal economic situation, the school union's operational firms face significant challenges. Among these concerns are the following:

1. What packaging strategy would minimise damage along the distribution channel?
2. How can packaging be used to boost sales volume effectively?
3. What is the most effective method for a company to create the illusion of inches through packing?

Packaging should be made of a robust and long-lasting material that will withstand competition. Product manufacturing firms have primarily ignored packaging. Corporations haven't paid attention to how vital vote packaging is to their survival (Ahmed & Khan, 2015). Regardless of the critical role packaging plays in a corporation, it raises several issues within and outside the schools for businesses and society. According to this project, when it comes to implementing the marketing mix, most enterprises face one or more cases. If these people are to advance in their respective fields, they must recognise and address these issues (Ahmed & Khan, 2015). The following points can be linked to packaging in terms of how it affects customer behaviour through promotion:

- 1) A well-designed and packed product can make you want to buy something right away.
- 2) How will a change in package design affect a consumer's(students) purchase decision?

1.3 RESEARCH QUESTIONS

In this study, the following research questions are generated:

1. Are products perceived better when they're packaged well?
2. Is packaging able to satisfy the mutual interests of both items and consumers?
3. What is the most appropriate packaging approach that your favourite drink brand should implement to improve consumer satisfaction?
4. Should packaging design be a combination of valuable values, such as convenience?
5. Does a change in a package design can influence a consumer's choice of goods?
6. A well-packaged product has a better chance of self-promotion without the seller having to say many convincing words.

1.4 OBJECTIVE OF THE STUDY

The thesis aims to investigate customers' views on convenience products' packaging and their purchasing behaviour towards the role and significance of packaging in the marketing of student goods in the school market environment.

The specific goals of the study are to find out if.

- The packaging has a significant impact on sales volume and profit.
- Whether packaging achieves the purpose of appealing to the interests of the students.
- To determine the relationship between effective packaging measures and increased market share in the school environment,
- To determine how the superior packaging method around the school's market environment improves customer service and increases patronage,
- Finally, select the most acceptable packaging options that students' favourite soft drink brands should employ to improve customer service.

1.5 SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

Packaging has an impact on how people buy things. This marketing strategy always includes a well-designed package, durability, and advertising. Often, they haven't been thoroughly checked, which can cause problems with what kind of package to use for a product.

Packaging is an essential part of the marketing mix, and you need to think about how customers will react to the package. Examining packaging as a way to promote yourself, point-of-sale displays, advertising for products, and durability are all essential parts of this kind of study.

The overall design should help customers recognise the brand among many competing products. Some companies are now rethinking their packages, especially aluminium cans and plastic bottles that can't be returned, like the ones used by beverage companies like Coca-Cola, Pepsi, and Kofola. These companies' introduction of canned and plastic soft drinks led me to choose this as the subject of my bachelor's thesis because I thought it was interesting.

1.6 SCOPE OF THE STUDY

This research investigates how students (customers) perceive the design of convenience product packages, how packaging influences consumer behaviour, and how packaging might be used as a marketing strategy for consumer goods. It also investigates how packaging influences impulsive purchasing and its role as a silent salesperson. The three soft drink firms utilised as case studies were Coca-Cola, Pepsi, and Kofola. They were all involved in producing soft drinks—students from the top three universities in the Czech Republic's city of Brno. Mendel University, Masaryk University, and the Brno University of Technology are among them.

1.7 ORGANISATION OF THE STUDY

This study has a total of five parts. A general introduction to the analysis is found in Chapter One, the first. Second, we'll look at how to answer research questions and build research models. Chapter three gives a general overview of the many ways models could be used to solve the problems in this bachelor's thesis. This study will investigate how the design of convenience product packets in school marketing affects people's purchasing decisions and how that affects what they buy. The fourth chapter talks about how to get and look at data and gives advice. The last chapter sums up the findings.

CHAPTER TWO

2.0 LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Conceptual Framework

This chapter talks about the study's findings and how they relate to the problems raised in Research Questions 1 and 2 in this chapter, which are also in this chapter. Break it into two parts. This part looks at how to package products affect customers' decisions to buy them, how they think about package products, and how they feel they affect their decisions to buy them. We'll also talk about how to answer research questions and build research models in the second part of this class. People could use many different models to help them with the study's problems, but not all of them are good. There is a summary of them in chapter three of the project.

2.1.0 Areas of Interest

This section of the literature study includes definitions and concepts about product packaging and buying intentions to give a complete picture of the terms used in this research.

2.1.1 Product Packaging and Element Packaging

Panwar (2004) defines packaging as "the process of enclosing, safeguarding, and presenting the contents through the long chain of production, handling, and transportation to their destinations in as good a state as they were at the time of production." Packaging is an important aspect of the branding process since it communicates a company's image and identity. (Sajuyigbe et al., 2013). Packaging is a product's container; it includes the physical appearance of the container as well as the design, colour, form, labelling, and materials utilised. Packaging has a significant impact on product positioning. Package design influences consumer impressions and can be a deciding factor in point-of-purchase decisions, which comprise the bulk of shopping experiences. According to Alice Louw (2006), the packaging is also significant in marketing. According to him, the best packaging creates a positive impression of the product in the minds of the consumers. According to Nilsson (2003), the box is the shopper's gateway to the goods because it often conveys the first impression of a brand, its

quality, or worth. When purchasing products that are not in their final shape, such as many food items, the consumer frequently relies on the package to build an impression of the product in its prepared state. This demonstrates the distinction between a package and a package. According to Underwood (2003), packages have intrinsic or extrinsic qualities dependent on their elements. According to Vazquez, Bruce, and Studd (2003), the pack must now come alive to represent the salesman at the point of purchase. Packages are now made for different occasions, different groups of people, and even for other businesses.

Because of this, however, Underwood (2003) says that the practical and emotional benefits of packaging are just like its symbolism. They are said to be important to the whole thing, especially for consumer goods that aren't very durable and don't have a lot of people who use them. It's important that packaging is thought of as a product-related quality in this study. It has both functional and sensory benefits, as well as symbolic benefits.

2.1.3 Elements of Product Packaging

According to Ampuero and Vila (2006), product packaging affects how people think about and respond to a product. The right combination of product packaging materials must be used (*ibid.*, p. 112). Like Underwood (2003), Vila and Ampuero (2006) say that product packaging has graphic and structural parts. Colour, type, shapes, and images are all examples of things that make up graphic elements. Structural parts of the packaging are things like the containers' shape, size, and material. (*ibid.*) When Rettie and Brewer (2000, as cited in Agariya et al., 2012) talk about product packaging, they say there are nonverbal and verbal parts. People who write about nonverbal aspects like Vila & Ampuero (2006) and Underwood (2003) state that they include visual and structural elements like colour and graphics. Verbal details give direct information to the consumer, like the product name, brand, manufacturer, country, and how to use it (Rettie & Brewer, 2000, cited in Agariya et al., 2012). Visual and verbal aspects are also separate in Agariya et al. (2012). For example, they say that graphics, colour, size, form, and material are all things that can be seen (product information, producer, country of origin, brand). Another classification is made by Silayoi and Speece (2004), who divides packaging into aesthetic and informational parts (information delivered). They gave a factual, but only theoretical, framework about how people think about things. The customers (students) are heard through a questionnaire survey in the research project.

2.1.4 Elements of Visual/Nonverbal Communication

People think of packages when they buy low-involvement products, where first impressions can last long (Silayoi & Speece, 2007, p. 1498). As a result, a product's packaging must be strong enough to make it stand out from other products on the shelf (Silayoi & Speece, 2007). "The package must draw attention" (Agariya et al., 2012, p. 3). Young (2010) found that more exposure on the shelf can lead to more sales. His research also found that a consumer's second look at a brand is a better predictor of whether or not they will buy something than a consumer's first impression. Customers who look at a brand again show that they are "rethinking a brand and adding it to their list of things to think about" (Young, 2010, p. 46). Suppose a product's packaging wants to be seen on the shelf and make people think twice about buying it. In that case, it needs to make a big difference from other products (Young, 2010.) Visual elements can also be used to communicate the product's features in a way that doesn't use words. For example, they can show elegance, femininity, and value (Agariya et al., 2012). Silayoi and Speece (2007) think that colours and graphics are two of the essential parts of low-involvement product packaging because these two elements are "very noticeable" (p. 1498).

According to Hine, individuals consider colours on a physiological, cultural, and personal level (Underwood, 2003). Colour reactions are universal and automatic, but cultural meanings vary from country to country (Underwood, 2003). A long-term marketing campaign can make customers associate specific colours with certain types of products. This makes them expect or prefer certain hues for certain products (Underwood, 2003; Silayoi & Speece, 2007). Examples of graphics include how images are arranged, how colours are combined, how typography is used, how forms are used, logos, and how products are shown (Silayoi & Speece, 2007; Underwood et al., 2001; Underwood, 2003). Graphics are important because they help make the package look whole (Silayoi & Speece, 2007). Underwood and Klein (2002) looked into how customers think about brands and how they feel about packages and brands. Product images can be used to tell people about a brand and change how they think about it. The more product images were added to the package, the more positive people thought about the brand and the package. (ibid.) Rettie and Brewer (2000) stress the importance of where graphic elements are placed. They say that people remember verbal information better if they put it on the left and that visual features are better if they are on the right (ibid). There are also things like the size, shape, form, and materials used that make things look good. These things are also thought to show a lot about a product's nature and personality (Underwood, 2003, p. 66).

Different container sizes might meet the needs of other people. Silayoi and Speece (2007) According to Young (2004), a shape can show things like heritage, taste, and quality.

According to research, changes in packaging shape have a more significant impact on how visible it is on the shelf than changes in the design of the package or the size of the package (ibid). In addition, product packaging is an essential part of developing a brand's look and identity (Underwood, 2003). "The packaging form can be a creative marketing tool to build a strong brand image" (Agariya et al., 2012, p. 12).

2.2 THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.2.1 The congruence theory of self-conception

In this theoretical concept, the theories, and models about how product packaging affects customer choice are covered in this part of the literature review, where you read about the research and models. Gardner and Levy (1955) said that brand image impacts whether someone buys something from a company or how people think about a brand. This is what they said. When Levy (1959) wrote about symbols for sale, it added more weight to this idea. This is how it works: During his work, Levy (1959) talked about how people think about themselves. He said that the brand image and how the self-concept and the brand image match up affect how people act when they see the brand.

2.2.1.1 In products, there are a lot of languages that aren't very real.

How can you figure out why people choose one brand over another? It would be better if you knew more about products' social and psychological dynamics (Gardner & Levy, 1955, p. 34). People buy things not only for what they can do but also for how they look, says Levy (1959). (p. 118). When people buy something, they think about how important they are to them and how well they work. It is possible to see products as symbols of your traits, goals, and how society tries to be better. On the other hand, a symbolic value "doesn't live in the object itself, but rather in how humans classify it." This is what Levy wrote in 1959. (Grubb & Grathwohl, 1967, p. 25). People seem to be able to tell brands apart based on "subtle changes in how they think about them" (Gardner & Levy, 1955, p. 35). Customers' thoughts and feelings about brands also play a role in which ones they think are right and which ones they choose to use

and sell (ibid.). He looks at "standards he's set for what is important to him or could be important to him." This helps him figure out the customer's needs (Levy, 1959, p. 119). The first time you buy something, you have to figure out whether or not it has the correct symbolism for you to use. When you use symbols, only use them if they make sense. A symbol is said to fit or be right if it helps people keep or improve their self-image. People will also use and enjoy things. Lofgren (2006) found that packaging design can make a product look better. Azad and Hamdavi pour (2011) said that only informational aspects make a person more likely to buy something. Soft drink companies in Brno, Czech Republic, need to learn more about the traits that people want in their products.

2.2.2 Self-Concept

The term "self-concept" refers to how someone thinks about themselves. Another congruity in the consumer behaviour literature is when a consumer compares the functional attributes of a product or brand to their ideal expectations. This is how consumers think about the product or brand (Ahn et al., 2013). In more specific terms, functional consistency is "the match between consumers' ideal expectations of utilitarian brand features and how they think the product is perceived along with the same features" (Kressmann et al., 2006, p. 955). A simple way to think about this is that the more closely the perceived functional attributes of the product or brand match the consumer's desired product or brand features, the more likely the consumer will be to buy that product or brand (Sirgy et al., 1). There is a lot of evidence that functional congruity can affect people's behaviour in many different ways. This includes the automobile industry (Kressmann et al., 2006), the housing market (Andersson et al., 2019), restaurants (Kang et al., 2015), hotels (Sop & Kozak, 2019), and tourist destinations (Bosnjak et al., 2011). Self-concept and functional congruity are not competing with each other but rather complement each other. To better understand consumer behaviour, both theories should be examined together (Sirgy et al., 2000, 2005, 2016; Sirgy & Su, 2000). This is because, even though cognitive and emotional evaluations are separate, emotions also affect cognition. That's what they found after they did four different studies. They discovered that self-concept directly affects consumer behaviour. Still, it also has an indirect effect through functional congruity. The evaluation of self-concept leads to a motivational tendency that changes how people think about functional congruities. Those with a high self-concept are more likely to be optimistic about available attributes, and vice versa. "SELF CONCEPT bias" is a term used in the

literature to describe this kind of motivational tendency (Sirgy et al., 2000). Tourists who think a destination matches or doesn't match their own self-image are more likely to have a positive (negative) first impression, which affects how they feel about the destination in the future (Sirgy & Su, 2000). That means that people who have a lot of stress in their lives are more likely to rate the functional attributes of a place well, which leads to high functional incongruity (and vice versa). Functional congruity and self-concept have both been shown to affect consumer behaviour. Some studies say that functional congruity has a more considerable effect on consumer behaviour than self-concept (Su & Reynolds, 2017). The consumer's knowledge of the product, previous experience, time pressure, or involvement may also play a role in how vital functional connection and self-concept are to them when it comes to their behaviour (Sirgy et al., 2000; Sirgy & Su, 2000). . Levy (1959) looked at how the self-concept and the brand image match up. Product packaging can be seen as a way to spread the word about a company's brand.

2.3 EMPIRICAL STUDIES

Researchers have found that packaging is a way to communicate a brand's image because of the idea that a person's self-image and the brand's image should match. Packaging is a product feature that significantly impacts the development and communication of a brand's identity. People say that "brand image" and "brand identity" are the same thing, but Underwood (2003) disagrees. Packaging is a feature of a product that customers notice. Product packaging can be seen as a way to spread the word about a company's brand.

It establishes a person's brand identity and how they look. The packaging tells people about a product's experiential, practical, and symbolic brand value. The benefits are shown and lived by the people who buy the product, so they learn about them. Packages come with sensory representations (e.g., visuals) of ideas, feelings, memories, and cognitive stimulation that people can use. People may prefer some brands because they think they are more reliable than others.

CHAPTER THREE

Methodology

Based on the ideas and models in the literature study, this research aims to find out how packaging design affects students' purchasing decisions. Underwood's (2003) conceptual model of product packaging, Agariya et al.'s (2012) framework for product packaging, features of the package, and customer behaviour on package product design are the three models most relevant to this thesis. These models are:

Table 3.0 Purpose and Research Questions

PURPOSE: This study aims to better understand the impact of product packaging on students' (consumer) buying decisions on certain packaged products.

Research Questions

- How does the packaging of a product help customers make a decision?
- Does a new package design make a person choose a different kind of product?

Although the literature review provides an overview of the research issue, it is vital to focus on the concepts that cross the critical topics of this study. As stated in Table 3, this study focuses on two crucial categories: *Purchasing decisions and Product packaging*.

RESEARCH DESIGN

A questionnaire was used to get data for this bachelor's project thesis, and a deductive method was used. This data was used to look at the answers to the research questions and find out which factors significantly impact how people think about the quality of a product when they buy it at a market, in a school, or in a business centre.

For the bachelor's research project, "soft drinks" were the chosen product type. Knowing that these products are often used by a wide range of student groups in different schools, this list was made. The scope of this research thesis is limited to three different brands of soft drinks that students drink in other schools. According to the findings of this study, one-third of students at the mentioned universities drink at least one to two bottles (or more) of their favourite brand every week.

This study was based on students' perceptions from three universities in Brno, Czech Republic: **Mendel University, Masaryk University, and the Brno University of Technology**. Students to like Cola-cola drinks better than other drinks from this study. It's also one of the fastest-growing soft drink markets in Brno, Czech Republic, where Coca- is a presence. This is because Coca-Cola is always coming up with new products and making changes.

The study's goods came from the "soft drinks" product category because the statistical difference between the selected products per product group is slight. This means that one can be sure that differences in packaging design cues cause any differences in product perception based on visual exposure to packaging. There are at least three different ways to package the different types of products.

As a result, many different brands are competing in graphic design. Producers spend a lot of time and money on labelling and packaging design to get the consumer's attention, set reasonable expectations about the goods, and make them want to buy the product before choosing a brand. Every product package screams for attention, and each one tells you that it's better, healthier, and tastier than the one that came before it. In addition, most dairy businesses have made sugary and watery drinks, but Coca-Cola drinks have seen a significant rise in marketing.

SAMPLE AND POPULATION

According to Sekaran (2004), "the population" refers to the entire group of people, events, or things the researcher wishes to investigate. The population of this study is made up of university students from the top three universities in Brno, Czech Republic. A convenience package sample of prominent soft drink brands with university students as customers was distributed among the listed universities to provide a high degree of representation for the research population. A total of 10 questionnaires were issued asked about their favourite soft

drinks in person. As a result of this procedure, 35 responses were obtained. This study was conducted on several types of soft drink brands from the top three colleges in Brno, Czech Republic, as an example of a consumer product.

RESEARCH PURPOSE

The study's goal can be to explain, describe, or explore. Explanatory studies try to figure out what causes things to happen. Descriptive studies give an accurate picture of people, events, or situations. They could be seen as extensions or precursors of exploratory research or explanations of things. This thesis aims to learn more about how packaging affects a brand's image and how customers choose to buy certain packaged products. The goal is to show how products are packaged and how people (students) think about them.

METHODS OF DATA COLLECTION

A questionnaire was used to collect primary data, while previous studies and the literature were used to collect secondary data. It took around five weeks to complete the distribution and collection activities. Respondents chose their favourite soft drink brand. Respondents were asked to share their experience with the package of their famous soft drink brand with the description above.

DEPENDABILITY AND VALIDATION

Whether or not the researcher did a good job measuring what they were supposed to be measuring or if the research findings are correct is known as the study's validity (Joppe, 2000). In Brno, study was done with questionnaires from three universities to see how the research tool worked. This higher level of analysis allowed the researcher to change any unclear items and make sure everyone could understand them. If you're having a hard time answering a question, you'll be able to use easier words instead. In addition to fundamental statistical analysis, you need to know how to look at historical data. The correlated data results were in line with the theoretical analysis made in Chapter 2. This shows that the reliability results of the current study are reasonable.

METHODS FOR DATA ANALYSIS

This research thesis used a survey to learn about students' perspectives on how well-packed products influence their purchasing decisions. The data collected is what is analysed using basic statistical concepts. The data was shown on pie charts and bar charts, demonstrating the significant variation among the decisions made. Data from previous experiences (history) was used as a yardstick to measure the corresponding answers and draw conclusions.

STRATEGY FOR RESEARCH

This study plan was chosen before data gathering could begin. According to Yin (2003), there are five research strategies: experiment, survey, archive analysis, history, and case study. These can be utilised in exploratory, descriptive, or explanatory research (Yin, 2003, cited in Saunders et al., 2007). In this study, I choose this suitable study strategy to determine the actual behavioural relationship between packaged soft drink products and students' decision to purchase such products.

The first and most important thing to keep in mind with this research topic is that the research strategy will be based on this. "What" questions often mean that someone wants to find out more. In this case, any of the research methods will work. "How many" and "how much" are two different types of "what" questions that are best answered by surveys or by looking at old records. This led to the design of a questionnaire to aid my survey. "Who" and "where" questions show that surveys or old documents are the best way to discover people's thoughts.

This was done in the questionnaire when students thought about how packaging makes them buy things. History, experiments, and case studies are the best ways to answer "why" and "how." Yin (20) talks about formalised. The second thing that determines the study method is how much control you have over what people do. This experiment is the only research method in which I can change the behaviour of the person I am studying. In other study methods, the researcher doesn't have any say over what people do.

Case studies, experiments, surveys, archival analysis, and histories could be used to look into a recent event. A case study will be used to write this thesis because the researchers don't have

much say in what happens. In history, the focus is on what happened in the past rather than what is happening now.

CASE STUDY

A case study of this research technique incorporates an empirical investigation of specific contemporary occurrences in real-life environments (schools) using various data sources.

In this case study, effectiveness for acquiring a complete grasp of the research context and the processes is being enacted.

This case study investigated a subject that few people have previously considered. Single-case approaches and multiple-case techniques were the two categories. This study will be conducted to examine the effect of product packaging on a customer's total purchasing decision.

CHAPTER FOUR

4.1 DATA ANALYSIS

Data analysis is an essential component of research. Data collected is only helpful if it is evaluated and its meaning is comprehended. (Saunders and colleagues, 2007) Data analysis entails gathering and sorting data to allow the researcher to derive the essential conclusions for the study (Yin, 2011). This section describes how the data obtained for this thesis will be analysed. Saunders et al. (2007) distinguish between two approaches to qualitative research: inductive and deductive. Researchers use an inductive technique when they construct a theory based on evidence acquired. A deductive method shapes the strategy taken to the qualitative research process by drawing on current theory. According to Yin (2003), when researchers have already used existing theories to generate their research questions, like in this thesis, it is also recommended to employ the same approaches to develop a framework that guides the analysis of the acquired data. The benefit of analysing data theoretically is that it provides researchers with an initial analytical framework to assist them in getting started.

Furthermore, this makes it easier to integrate the findings of a study into the existing body of knowledge in the research field (Saunders et al., 2007). Miles and Huberman (2014) define analysis as three activities: data compression and display, conclusion drawing, and verification.

Data reduction is the process of choosing, focusing, simplifying, abstracting, and changing data derived from field notes or transcriptions. The assembling of acquired data that allows researchers to form conclusions is known as a data display. Data reduction and data display require data categorisation and unitisation.

The categorisation is the classification or grouping of acquired data into meaningful categories that can be studied. Data unitisation entails allocating relevant data units to matching categories. Miles and Huberman present data analysis within and between cases (2014). Pattern matching is an analytical technique that is particularly well suited to case studies. "Predicting a pattern of outcomes based on theoretical propositions" is what this entails.

4.1.0 Demographics of respondents

As shown in fig 4.0, male students made up 40% (14 people) of the respondents, while female students made up 60% (21 people) of them attended the survey interview, 35 were respondents which is shown in the table. The majority of the students who answered were women. All as shown in Figure 4.0

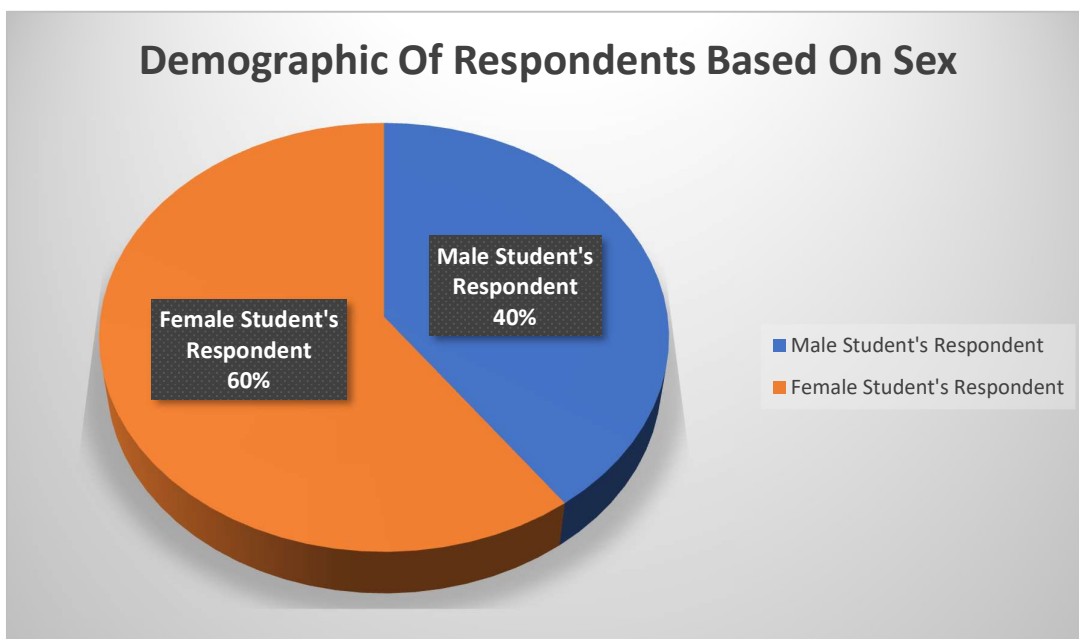


Fig 4.0 Total Percentage of Respondents

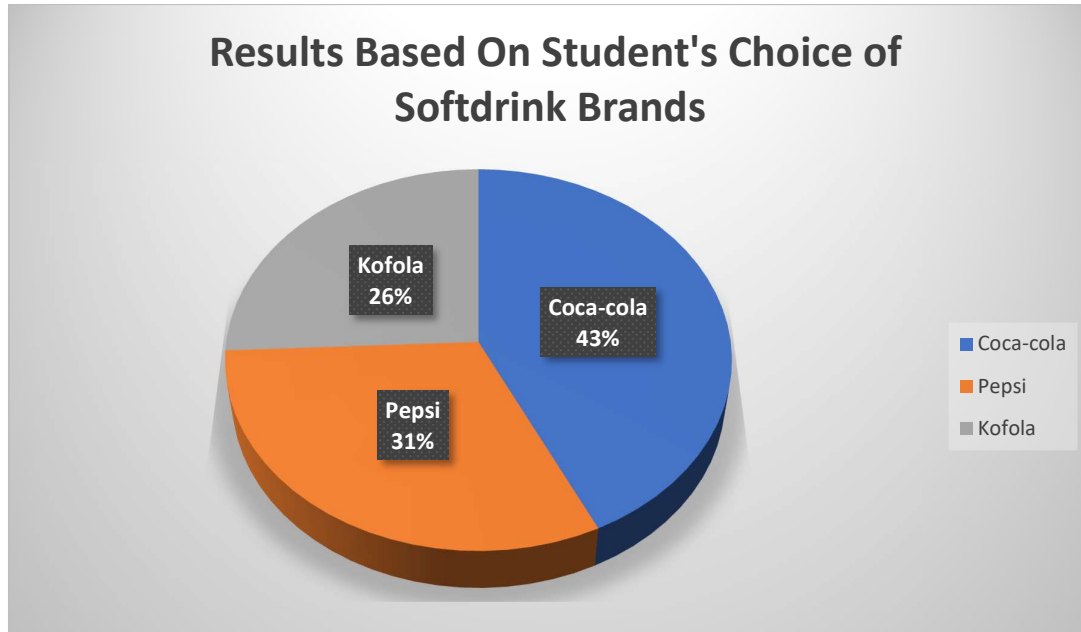


Fig 4.1 Respondents' Result on Their Favourite Soft Drink Brand

Source: Field Work

From fig 4.1 is the result of based on my survey interview. Most of the students choose Coca-Cola over Pepsi and Kofola. Which is 43% (15 people). The reason behind of popularity of coca cola is brand image and their Brite colour of packaging. On the other hand, Pepsi and Kofola liked by 31% and 26% people.

4.1.1 Descriptive Statistical Data

Based on the study sample, the average number of students who pick packaging because they like their favourite soft drinks brands is rated as the independent variable. Other variables, like the current program of studies, age, and school, were also calculated to see how important each was. The instrument used in the study was scaled in this way:

Table 4.0 The table presents the survey results showcasing the views of customers (students) on several questions related to packaging and product perception across three different beverage brands: Coca-Cola, Pepsi, and Kofola

		Packaging is the reason liking the brand?		Are product perceived better when they are package well?		A new packaging influence you to choose the drink?		Do you want any changes in product design?	
		Agree	Disagree	Agree	Disagree	Agree	Disagree	Agree	Disagree
1.	Coca-Cola	100% (15)	0%	80% (12)	20% (3)	90% (14)	10% (1)	66% (10)	34% (5)
2.	Pepsi	100% (11)	0%	100% (11)	0%	54% (6)	46% (5)	36% (4)	64% (7)
3.	Kofola	33% (3)	77% (6)	100% (9)	0%	100% (9)	0%	0%	100% (9)

Table 4.0 Source: Field Work

This table shows that about the question I asked during the survey. As we can see for Pepsi and Coca-Cola 100% people agree that packaging is the reason liking the brand but on the other hand Kofola 77% disagree that packaging is not the reason liking the brand there is other reason liking the brand. Coca-Cola and Pepsi customers both showed high agreement (80% and 90%, respectively) that products are perceived better when packaged well, with a minority in disagreement. All Kofola customers (100%) agreed that products are perceived better when packaged well, with none in disagreement. If company want to change packaging, then most of the customer want to try their favourite brand drinks. But when we look at the next question do they want to change the product design as we can see a majority of Coca-Cola customers (66%) expressed a desire for changes in product design, while 34% disagreed. Pepsi customers were almost evenly split, with 36% agreeing and 64% disagreeing. 100% people from Kofola doesn't want to change the product design.

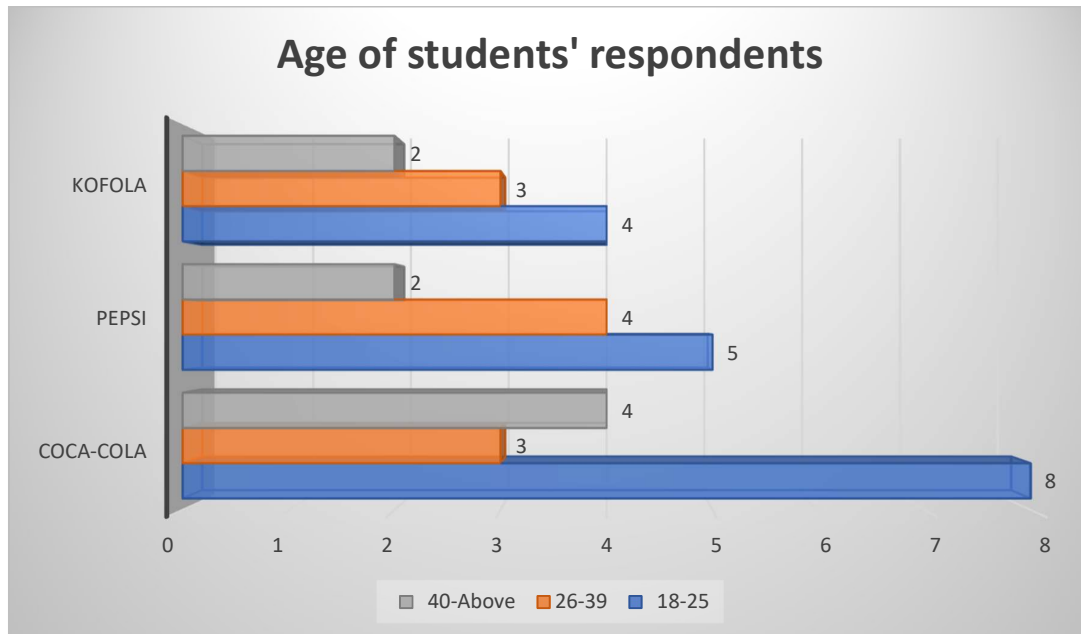


Fig 4.2 Demographic Characteristics of The Respondent's Age

For this project, we used age data to figure out which soft drink brands students like best, which will help us choose the packaging for the products. As shown in figure 4.3, there were three age groups, with the university being the most common. Coke and Pepsi are more popular with people between the ages of 18 to 25 than Kofola drinks, which aren't very popular. Coca-Cola was less popular drink for people between the ages of 26 to 39 master's students. who are older than 40, get the least amount of review for this study.

Characteristics	Frequency	Percentage
Sex		
Male	14	60%
Female	21	40%
Age		
18 - 25	17	48%
26 - 39	10	28%
40 - above	8	22%
Current program of studies		
Bachelor	14	40%
Masters	12	35%
Doctorate	9	25%
Name Of School		
Mendel University	11	32%
Masaryk University	14	40%
Brno University of technology	10	28%

Table 4.1 Detailed Statistical Data Sets

Source: Field survey

From table 4.1 shows the summery of survey apart from the package related question. The number of students response in bachelor, master's, and doctorate. And we found that bachelor and master's student are more likely to have soft drinks than doctorate students. The majority of the students who responded to this question were Bachelors.

Source: Field work

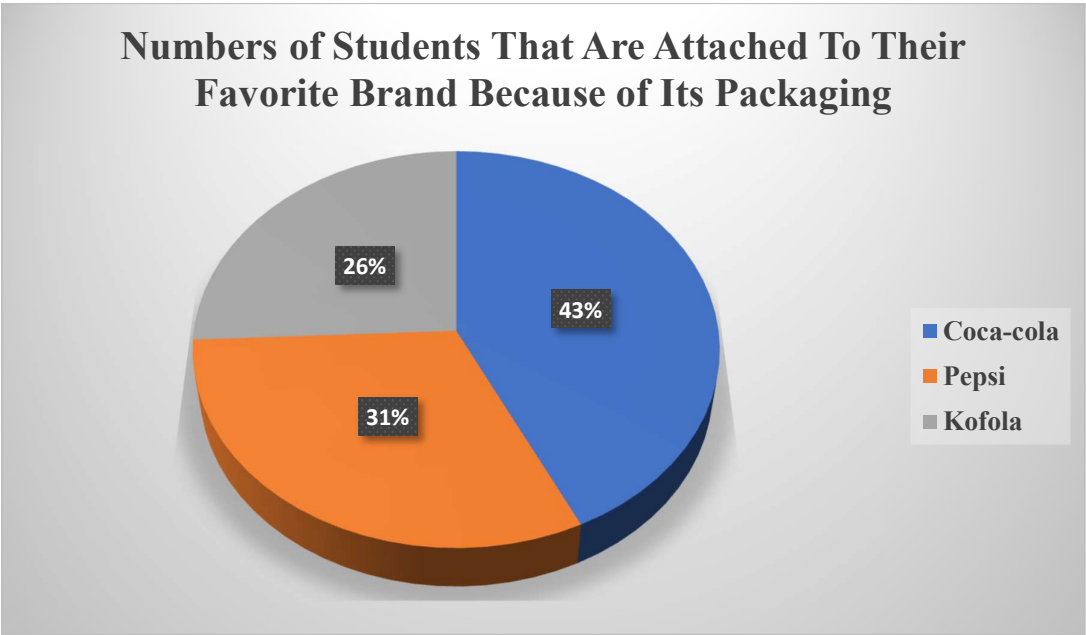


Fig 4.3 Numbers of Students That Are Attached to Their Favorite Brand Because of Its Packaging

The Fight 4.4 demonstrates that only 48% percent of 35 students who enjoy Coca-Cola soft drinks are attached to their packaging concept. In contrast, 36 % from all student respondents who wanted Pepsi agreed that packaging is the sole determining factor. Only 16 percent among 35 student respondents prefer Kofola drinks.

4.2 STATISTICAL ANALYSIS

For Coca-Cola Soft Drinks Brand.

Total number of respondents = 15

Percentage of students who responded with packaging as a reason for liking the brand = 100%

Percentage of students who responded with other factors as a reason = 0%

For Pepsi Soft Drinks Brand.

Total number of respondents = 11

Percentage of students who responded with packaging as a reason for liking the brand = 100%

Percentage of students who responded with other factors as a reason = 0%

For Kofola Soft Drinks Brand.

Total number of respondents = 9

Percentage of students who responded with packaging as a reason for liking the brand = 33%

Percentage of students who responded with other factors as a reason = 77%

Using average mean analysis for packaging convenience on customers (students)

$$(100+100+33)/3 = 77.6\%$$

Using average mean analysis for other factors enhancing convenience on customers (students)

$$(0+0+77)/3 = 25.6\%$$

Therefore, using **mode** analysis, 77.6% is the highest percentage rate.

This means that **packaging** influences the choice of purchasing decision more than any other factor.

Customers Opinion: My research is based on face-to-face interview form customer(students). The goal is also to find out the root cause of packaging and suggestion form customer by discussing the research question and asking them. During my survey my last question was for all the interviewer what improvement they want in their favourite brand packaging, and we received lots of opinion which made the research more interesting. I found that customer has different perspective. There is no doubt that Pepsi, coca cola, Kofola are well known brand and they good reputation. But my research forms the interview found that Pepsi and coca cola losing their loyal customer for some of their movement on the war issue of Palestine and Israel. Because of their one-sided support effected of group of community, which damaged brand imager and popularity. Another interesting fact found that people in Czech Republic are more likely to choose Kofola over Pepsi and coca cola. The reason found the Kofola is brand of their own country, and they are proud to have such brand like Kofola. Which is now getting popular rapidly in the middle Europe. And because of its various flavour make it different form other cold drinks. Even some of them want to change the colour of packaging and suggested to make similar to Czech flag colour. Another fact found that because of using plastic bottle one group of people who support green peace are now less interested to support all the cold drinks brand because of their plastic package product. And according to them every year millions of toun plastic west producing because of cold drinks packaging which is affecting nature.

4.3 DISCUSSION OF THE FINDINGS

According to the statistical analysis section of this research report, it can be found out that students from the universities mentioned above think about how easy it is to buy a product package at the store. The impact of these factors is then discussed.

It was found that "the role of packaging in students' (customers') purchasing decisions" significantly affects how easy it is for students and customers to buy a product with a good package. According to research, one of the essential roles or functions of packaging is to protect the products and the people who use them.

Based on students' opinions (buyers) about how good the soft drinks were when they bought them, "the role of packaging in advertising items" has a significant effect in Brno, the Czech Republic, where the three best universities are. This is based on Pires (2008), who found that

consistent colour, shape, and different sizes of product combinations are expected to make people think a product is better. It is also supported by a few other researchers, who found that there is a strong connection between the promotional role of packaging and how much people like good packaging. Silayoi and Speece (2004) found that package size and shape affect customer judgments and decisions about the quality of a product. They discovered that package size and shape affect customer judgments and decisions about the quality of a product. This is backed up by Lofgren (2006), who found that packaging design can make a product look better by making it easier to use. However, Azad and Hamdavi pour (2011) said that only informational aspects could make a person more likely to buy something. Visual features, on the other hand, were thought to be less effective. R.Baker (2008) also found that 59 percent of respondents said they would be more likely to buy a particular brand of a product whose packaging was less likely to harm the environment, while 20 percent said they wouldn't. Pelanic Chilufya (2020) found that 78 percent of Zambian customers are willing to pay more for access to environmentally friendly goods and that advertising is vital to get these products out there. Neff and Halliday's (2000) study found that people in the United States aren't willing to pay more for green products. D'souza et al. (2006) found that the only thing that made customers more convenient was their previous experience with the package patterns, not the perception of the following factors: product quantity and product quality. This finding, on the other hand, contradicts both studies.

Another thing to keep in mind is that product size comes first in order of importance. Then comes the quality of the package, the colour of the product, its form, and its content. If you think about how things work, how the variables are ranked is essential. The first thing to think about is the size of the product. Coca-Cola comes in various sizes, making it easy for people of all income levels to get their hands on them. This means that the way products are packaged should consider how much money people make. Customers should be grouped based on their income in this way. If you look at this project, you'll see that the two most popular soft drink brands are used mainly by students from the top-ranked school every day.

There should be more than one thing to think about when a manufacturer makes something. Colours have different meanings for different people and cultures. Some people might find black appealing, but others might find it unpleasant when it comes to traditions. If an attractive colour is used for packaging a product, but a repulsive colour is used to show it, the product may be unpleasant after you open the packaging. So, producers should try to use colours that mean the same thing in different cultures. If colour discrimination is not seen as appropriate,

the same product can be used in other traditions while still having the same quality. The fact that the quality of a package is linked to its size (ability to buy) is not a coincidence. Purchased supplies may not be used all at once, so they must be stored for a few days. The best packaging that can keep a product fresh for a few days is vital to the people who buy it. People in Brno use this to keep things fresh today: fridges and freezers. Producers should think about making packing materials that can keep things safe for a few days. It should be necessary for the package to think about the nature of the product when it comes to this. As an example, the taste of Kofola will change if you let it get a little bit of fresh air. Packages for soft drinks should be made to be airtight, and all sizes should be made so that the seal can be reattached if the contents are not drunk all at once.

Content quality did not mean that Coca-Cola and Pepsi's customers (students) didn't care about the quality of their products. Instead, we thought it was a sign that the customers were aware of the purpose of the study, which was to look at packaging rather than the quality of the products. Only after you buy something can you find out how good it really is. Also, the packaging can draw attention, which could lead to a sale. Customers may care about the shape of a product in several ways, including how easy it is to use. As soon as you buy a product, it is usually put in a regular or customised crate. This reduces the value of traits like being easy to find or being convenient quickly.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings, the study recommends the followings:

1. **Innovative Packaging Strategies:** Beverage companies should use the thing that make good packaging easy to use as an incentive for people to buy their products. For example, ecofriendly material, innovative design, resealable design. As a result, the company's competitive advantage will improve, and its market share will increase, so this will happen. It can improve image value of the product and attract more customers.
2. **Consumer Engagement Strategies:** It is essential for soft drink manufacturers and distributors in Brno, Czech Republic, to learn more about the traits that people want in their products by taking regular polls of people, hearing their praise, or coming up with new ideas. For example, before launching a new flavour they can create Taste Testing Events, social media listening, feedback form, focus group diverse groups of consumers

to delve deeper into their preferences, habits, and perceptions related to soft drinks. In this way they will get to know more about their customer and other soft drinks customer too.

3. **Maximizing Sales Through Strategic Packaging Promotion and Design:** To make the package look more appealing, pay special attention to its promotional role because it plays a significant role in getting people to buy it. Because people have different views on things, it's crucial to think about using a variety of channels to strengthen this role. By coming up with and putting together promotional programs on time. Eye catching design vibrant colours, bold typography, and attractive graphics. On packager promotion by giving discount and coupons.
4. **Fostering Brand Loyalty and Accessibility Among Students:** To build a unique and competitive position, soft drink companies and marketers around the school environment in Brno, Czech Republic, must always try to get better. This might require them to know a lot about their customers' recreational habits and preferences, which might require them to develop new products or redesign old ones. Community Engagement with the student community through events, sponsorships, and partnerships with student organizations. This helps build brand loyalty among students. Ensure that soft drink products are readily available and accessible to students in school environments by partnering with school cafeterias, vending machine operators, or convenience stores.
5. **Unlocking Sales Potential:** The packaging design significantly impacts how easy it is for people to buy things. Previous research found that many aspects of packaging design, such as image, size, colour, and form, had a significant impact. They'll accept simple instructions on the box and a package that is easy to handle, open, or close. All these things help to get people's attention and interest. Eye-catching graphics, imagery, and colours can grab consumers' attention and stand out on store shelves amidst competitors. The combination of these features makes the product more appealing. Colours specific emotions and perceptions in consumers. The choice of colours in packaging design can influence how consumers perceive the product and brand. For example, bright and vibrant colours may suggest energy or excitement, while muted tones may convey sophistication or elegance.
6. **Embracing Regional Flavors and Preferences:** We know that Pepsi and Coca-Cola are famous worldwide than Kofola but if they follow the strategy of Kofola by adding

various flavour like Kofola by doing the market research of local fruit flavour famous based of country to country. They can get loyal customer like Kofola we found form survey. Conduct thorough market research in each country or region to identify popular local fruit flavours and beverage preferences. This could involve surveys, taste tests, and consumer interviews to understand the unique tastes of the target market. Develop new soft drink variants or flavours inspired by local fruits and ingredients that resonate with consumers' palates. This could include regional specialties such as mango, lychee, guava, or regional herbs and spices.

7. **Enhancing Brand Visibility and Consumer Engagement Through Color-Coded Packaging:** Kofola can also change the colour of packaging and drink based of flavour to attract more customers. Appealing colours can catch the eye of consumers, drawing their attention to the product. By aligning the colour of the packaging with the flavour of the drink, consumers can easily identify their preferred flavour immediately. Brands can colour-changing packaging for seasonal promotions or limited-edition flavours. This creates a sense of urgency and exclusivity, encouraging consumers to try the new offerings before they're gone.

CHAPTER FIVE

5.0 CONCLUSION

Packaging is important because, according to many different researchers, a well-packaged product can help a company be more successful. A good product positioning strategy is often linked to success. It has been found that strategic product packaging can make people buy things they don't want to buy. In other words, a good package is a powerful weapon that can make people in Brno, the Czech Republic, more interested in Coca-Cola products. Based on this research, the study said that different package sizes should be encouraged so that buyers can choose based on how much they use.

In the same way, businesses should choose their colour combinations very carefully to pique customers' interests and make them choose products based only on how the boxes look. The package should be made of a high-quality material that allows people to keep the product for a long time and maybe even use the container for other things after the content is gone.

Packaging is an essential part of the marketing communication of goods, and it can be used as one of the main factors that make people buy things. It can't be overstated how important packaging is to any business that wants to make money from customers. Packaging is a powerful tool that makes people want to buy things. Lamb et al. say that packaging plays four essential roles: containment, promotion, protection, use, and ease of use.

Packaging design is essential for supermarket products because its main job is to separate them. Packages use design, colours, shapes, graphics, and materials to get the recipient to open them. The package must act as a silent salesman and get the attention of the shopping person.

Product packaging is the process of designing and making the container or wrapper for a product. It tells people about the product's discrimination, ingredients, mode of use, expiration date, price, and warning—an ideal and beneficial development. Packaging design is shown as a package for a product that includes all these things. Because this thesis involves students, the economic position will not be compared to that of the rest of the globe. Poor financial situation has made it very difficult for any business to stay in business. Most companies that made products didn't pay much attention to packaging in the past.

Many businesses and society have problems with packaging, even though it is imperative to businesses and society as a whole. Poor packaging is an issue for most companies, say many people who worked on this project. When the Kofola drink brand didn't do very well, it had to change, so packages are more than just putting a label on a product with a pretty picture. They also have a lot more to them than that. Uniqueness: The fact that you can offer your product in different sizes to make it more convenient for people who want to buy it is what makes your package different.

This is also in line with what Young (2010) found in *Winning at the Two Moments of Truth*. Only packages that stand out from the rest of the visual clutter in a store have a chance to get attention from people. A product that can't be seen or heard can't be sold, so it can't be bought.

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